

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 7 4 2

♥ Q 8 2

♦ 7 4

♣ Q J 3

♠ A 10 6

♥ A 7 4

♦ K Q 10 2

♣ K 8 4



♠ Q 9

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ J 9 5

♣ A 10 7 2

♠ 8 5 3

♥ K 9 6

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 9 6 5

NORTH has a perfect 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

SOUTH has 7 points; he knows that the most points the partnership could hold is 24 (7 + 17). Since this is below the 26 point game requirement he passes.

West

Pass

North

1NT

*East**South*

All Pass

1NT by North

Lead: ♥3

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 9 6
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 8 4

♠ K J 6 5

♥ 7 5 3

♦ A 6

♣ 10 7 3 2



♠ A Q 4

♥ K 10 8

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ A Q 6

♠ 8 3 2

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ 8 4 2

♣ J 9 5

EAST has an ideal 1NT opening - 16 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, WEST knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game but not enough to think about slam. Since WEST also has a balanced hand she bids 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠ 3

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 5
♥ Q J 10 5 3
♦ 8 2
♣ J 8 4 3

♠ A J 3
♥ A 8 7
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ Q 10 7



♠ 10 9 6 4
♥ 4 2
♦ K 7 6 3
♣ K 9 2

♠ K Q 8 2
♥ K 9 6
♦ A 9 4
♣ A 6 5

SOUTH has 16 points and balanced distribution. She naturally opens 1NT.

NORTH has 14 points and balanced distribution so he does the math. The partnership has at least 29 points (14 + 15). The partnership has at most 31 points (14 + 17).

Since this is more than the 26 needed for game, but fewer than the 33 needed for slam NORTH just bids 3NT, knowing SOUTH will respect his decision and pass.

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥Q			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 9 6
♥ A J 5
♦ A Q J
♣ A 9 3 2

♠ 10 4 3
♥ K 10 9 6 3
♦ K 10
♣ Q J 10

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 5 2
♥ 8 7 2
♦ 9 4 3
♣ 7 6 5

♠ Q 8 7
♥ Q 4
♦ 8 7 6 5 2
♣ K 8 4

When WEST opens 1NT, EAST knows that he cannot have more than 17 points. So with her 7 points, she knows there is no reason to respond.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

All Pass

1NT by West

Lead: ♣Q

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 7 5 4

♥ 8 7 6

♦ 10

♣ A 8 4 2

♠ K Q J

♥ Q J 9 5

♦ A J 8

♣ Q J 10

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 2

♥ A 10 3

♦ Q 9 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 6 3

♠ 10 8 6 3

♥ K 4 2

♦ K 4 3

♣ K 7 5

NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT opener.

SOUTH has 9 points: - if NORTH has 15 the total is 24, not enough for game. - if NORTH has 17 the total is 26, enough for game. Since SOUTH doesn't know what to do he passes the buck back to NORTH by bidding 2NT; this is an invitation for NORTH to bid game.

NORTH has a maximum 17 point hand so she accepts the invitation.

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♦ 6

North

1NT

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 8 4
♥ K 7 2
♦ Q 6 5
♣ K J 9 3

♠ Q 3

♥ J 10 9 5

♦ 8 7 3 2

♣ 7 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 9 7 6

♥ A Q 4

♦ A J 4

♣ Q 10 8

♠ K J 5 2

♥ 8 6 3

♦ K 10 9

♣ A 6 4

With 9 points WEST is unable to decide the final contract. If EAST has 17 points then the partnership should be playing 3NT. If EAST opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So WEST makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells EAST that he must make the final call - go on to game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal EAST has 17 points so he bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1NT	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠ 2			

Board 7

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 9 7
♥ Q 6 5 4 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ Q 3

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ A 7 3

♦ 10 8 4

♣ 8 7 4



♠ 8 5 3

♥ J 10

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ A J 6 2

♠ A 10 6

♥ K 9 8

♦ A J 2

♣ K 10 9 5

This time SOUTH has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

NORTH has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between 24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

SOUTH, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2NT		
All Pass			
2NT by South			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

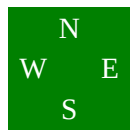
♠ K Q 6
♥ A J 10 3
♦ A Q
♣ K J 5 2

♠ A 9 8

♥ Q

♦ K 10 9 8 6

♣ A Q 10 4



♠ J 7 4 2

♥ 8 5

♦ J 4 2

♣ 9 8 7 3

♠ 10 5 3

♥ K 9 7 6 4 2

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 6

WEST has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution. It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

EAST adds her 2 points to WEST's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

All Pass

2NT by West

Lead: ♦ 10

Board 9

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 2

♥ J 8

♦ 6 5 3 2

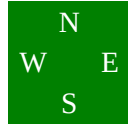
♣ 6 4 2

♠ A 10 8

♥ A 10 9

♦ K Q 10 8

♣ K 9 7



♠ 6 5 4

♥ K 6 5 4 3

♦ A 7

♣ A 5 3

♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ J 9 4

♣ Q J 10 8

NORTH has an mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

SOUTH has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking NORTH to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But NORTH has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice. In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points. Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good" and bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 9 6 2

♥ K 7 5

♦ 9 5 4

♣ K Q 6

♠ 8 7 3

♥ 10 9 8 6 2

♦ A 7

♣ 5 4 2



♠ K Q J

♥ A 4

♦ K Q 10 8

♣ A J 7 3

♠ A 5 4

♥ Q J 3

♦ J 6 3 2

♣ 10 9 8

EAST has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution, so he opens 2NT.

WEST has 8 points. She adds EAST's 20 or 21 for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she bids 3NT and EAST passes.

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♥Q

Board 11

East Deals

None Vul

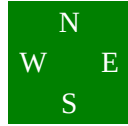
♠ J 3 2
 ♥ A 8 4
 ♦ 9 8 7 4 3
 ♣ 9 4

♠ A 10 8

♥ K J 3

♦ A J 5

♣ Q J 7 2



♠ 9 7 6 5
 ♥ 10 7 6 2
 ♦ 10
 ♣ A 10 6 5

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K Q 6 2

♣ K 8 3

SOUTH has a low-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

NORTH has 16 points; he figures the partnership holds either 31, 32 or 33. Obviously he wants to at least reach game, but if SOUTH holds 17 points he wants to reach slam.

NORTH bids 4NT. Since this is more than game it should be clear to SOUTH that he is asking her to bid 6NT if she is at the top of her range. It is clear to SOUTH, but with just 15 points she passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			
4NT by South			
Lead: ♥8			

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 5
♥ K 8 5
♦ Q 10 7 6
♣ A 9 7

♠ K 3 2
♥ J 10 9 3 2
♦ 8
♣ Q J 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ K J 3
♣ K 10 5 2

♠ J 9 7 6
♥ A 4
♦ A 9 5 4 2
♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2NT	
All Pass			
2NT by West			
Lead: ♥J			

WEST has a minimum 1NT opening hand - balanced distribution with 15 points.

EAST has 9 points, which is not enough to bid game, but is worth making an invitational bid. So she says 2NT.

Since WEST is minimum he declines the invitation by passing.

Board 13

West Deals

None Vul

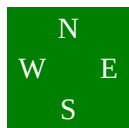
♠ 9 7 2
♥ 10 9 7 5
♦ J 10 9 3
♣ 8 4

♠ Q J 4

♥ A K

♦ K 7 6

♣ Q J 10 5 2



♠ A 8 6 3

♥ J 8 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ 9 7 6

♠ K 10 5

♥ Q 6 3

♦ A Q 5 4

♣ A K 3

NORTH has 17 points, counting 1 for the fifth Club.
She has a balanced distribution so she opens 1NT.

SOUTH is also balanced, so he does the math.

NORTH has either 15, 16 or 17, and with SOUTH's 18 the partnership total is either 33, 34 or 35. That is enough for a small slam, but below the 37 points needed for Grand Slam so he bids 6NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	1NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♥2			

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7 4
♥ Q J 5
♦ K J 10
♣ A 7 4 3

♠ 10 8 2

♥ 9 7 6 3

♦ 7 6

♣ J 10 9 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 9

♥ A K 8

♦ A Q 5 3

♣ K Q 8

♠ A 6 5 3

♥ 10 4 2

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ 5 2

The partner who is first sure what the final contract should be should just go ahead and bid it. This is called "She who knows, goes."

In this deal, for example, it is WEST who knows. She has a balanced 14 points, so when EAST indicates 20/21 points with his opening 2NT bid she KNOWS the partnership holds about 34/35 points.

Therefore she GOES to 6NT.

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

Lead: ♣5

Board 15

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J 4
♥ J 5 3
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ 8 3

♠ 8 5 3

♥ K 9 6

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 9 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 6

♥ A Q 4

♦ K Q J 10

♣ K J 7

♠ 9 7 2

♥ 10 8 7 2

♦ 2

♣ A Q 10 4 2

SOUTH has a balanced 20 point hand - ideal to open 2NT.

NORTH has 7 points; he knows the partnership has either 27 or 28 points so he bids 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠K

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 5
 ♥ 10 7 4 3
 ♦ A 9 8 2
 ♣ K Q

♠ Q J

♥ Q J 6 2

♦ 10 7 5

♣ 8 6 5 2



♠ 7 6 4

♥ A K 8

♦ K Q

♣ A J 10 7 4

♠ 10 9 8 3 2

♥ 9 5

♦ J 6 4 3

♣ 9 3

West

1NT

All Pass

6NT by West

Lead: ♠Q

North

Pass

East

6NT

South

This is another example of "She who knows, goes."

EAST has a solid 18 points, (1 extra for the fifth Club), so when WEST opens 1NT she KNOWS that together they must hold at least 33 points. They may even have 35 points.

In any case they should be in slam, so EAST GOES to 6NT.

Board 17

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 4
♥ K 7 6 4
♦ 8 6 2
♣ A J 6

♠ K J 9

♥ A Q

♦ K Q J 9 5

♣ K 10 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 7 2

♥ J 9 3 2

♦ 10 4

♣ 7 3 2

♠ 10 6 3

♥ 10 8 5

♦ A 7 3

♣ Q 9 8 5

NORTH has 20 points, counting one extra for the fifth Diamond. Just right to open 2NT.

SOUTH has 6 points, just enough to bid 3NT. (20 + 6 = 26) (21 + 6 = 27)

West

Pass

North

2NT

East

Pass

South

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♣3

Board 18

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 3
 ♥ K 10 6
 ♦ A 9 4
 ♣ 10 7 5 2

♠ 6
 ♥ Q J 7 4 2
 ♦ 6 3 2
 ♣ A 9 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 9 2
 ♥ A 9 8
 ♦ Q 10 8
 ♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 7 5 4
 ♥ 5 3
 ♦ K J 7 5
 ♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	1NT	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠ 5			

After WEST passes initially, EAST opens 1NT.

With 9 points, WEST has invitational strength, so he says 2NT.

EAST has a small problem - WEST's bid tells her to bid 3NT with 17 points, but to pass with 15 points. Her problem is that she has 16! Since it looks to her like a "good" 16 points she bids 3NT. If those 10's and 9's had been 4's and 3's she would have passed.

Board 19
 East Deals
 E-W Vul

♠ 6 2
 ♥ J 9 6 5
 ♦ Q 8 5 4
 ♣ 9 6 5

♠ A 7
 ♥ A 8 4
 ♦ K 10 6
 ♣ K J 7 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 5 4
 ♥ 7 3 2
 ♦ 9 3 2
 ♣ A 3

♠ K Q 9 3
 ♥ K Q 10
 ♦ A J 7
 ♣ Q 10 8

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♥5			

SOUTH has a great 1NT hand - 17 points and 4-3-3-3 shape.

NORTH has 16 points; he figures it is possible that SOUTH can make a slam, but only if she has a 17 point opener. So he bids 4NT, expecting SOUTH to bid 6NT if she has 17 points but to pass if she has fewer.

He figured right - SOUTH had 17 points so she bid 6NT.

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ Q 9 6
♦ K Q 5 2
♣ K J 8

♠ J 6 5 2
♥ 10 8 7 2
♦ 10 9 7
♣ A 4



♠ K 8
♥ A K 5
♦ A 8
♣ Q 10 9 6 3 2

♠ Q 10 9 3
♥ J 4 3
♦ J 6 4 3
♣ 7 5

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			
6NT by West			
Lead: ♥8			

EAST definitely does NOT have a balanced hand.
She has two doubletons and a 6-card Club suit.

But she DOES have 18 points, (two extra for the fifth and sixth Clubs), and her 18 added to WEST's minimum of 15 is enough to bid 6NT.

Notice how easy this will be to play once that Club suit is established.

Board 21

West Deals

None Vul

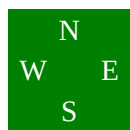
♠ A 6 5
♥ K Q 8 3
♦ Q 10 8 5
♣ 10 4

♠ Q J 10

♥ A J 7

♦ A K 6 2

♣ K Q J



♠ 9 7 4 2

♥ 10 4

♦ J 9

♣ A 9 7 6 3

♠ K 8 3

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ 7 4 3

♣ 8 5 2

With 21 points and 4-3-3-3 distribution, NORTH opens 2NT.

SOUTH has just 3 points; he knows that NORTH cannot have more than 21 so the partnership total cannot be more than 24. So he just passes 2NT.

West

Pass

North

2NT

*East**South*

All Pass

2NT by North

Lead: ♣6

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 5 3
 ♥ K 5 3
 ♦ K 5 3
 ♣ K 7 5 3

♠ J 9 8 7 6
 ♥ Q J 10 9
 ♦ 9 8
 ♣ 9 6



♠ A 4 2
 ♥ A 4 2
 ♦ A 6 4 2
 ♣ A 4 2

♠ Q 10
 ♥ 8 7 6
 ♦ Q J 10 7
 ♣ Q J 10 8

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♣Q

This is an easy one to bid.

EAST has a balanced 16 points so he opens 1NT.

WEST has a balanced 12 points so she responds 3NT.

BUT - just look at how this would play. You might only be able to take 8 tricks. Sometimes correct bidding gets you to unmakeable contracts. But it's only a game.

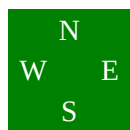
Board 23

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 6 4
♥ A 8 7 6
♦ 9 6 5 3
♣ 9 7

♠ K 7 2
♥ K J 5
♦ A 7 4 2
♣ Q J 8



♠ 10 9 8 3
♥ 4 2
♦ 10 8
♣ 10 5 4 3 2

♠ A J 5
♥ Q 10 9 3
♦ K Q J
♣ A K 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	6NT	Pass	2NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♥6			

Notrump bidding really is easy, you just add your points to partner's points and then bid according to that answer.

Here NORTH has 14 points. So when SOUTH opens 2NT, showing 20 or 21 points NORTH knows the total will come to 34 or 35 so he bids 6NT.

Board 24

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 6
♥ K 9 3
♦ K 7 4 3
♣ A 6 2

♠ 10 9 3

♥ J 10 6 5

♦ A 10

♣ K J 10 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 7 5

♥ Q 8 4

♦ Q 6 2

♣ Q 7 5 3

♠ J 8 4 2

♥ A 7 2

♦ J 9 8 5

♣ 9 4

EAST cannot open with only 8 points.

Furthermore, when WEST opens 1NT EAST knows that the partnership has a 25 points at most so he passes again.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

Pass

1NT

All Pass

1NT by West

Lead: ♥5